

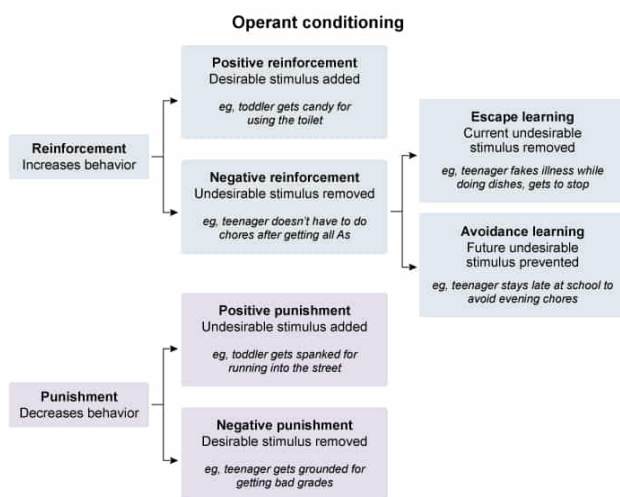
Researchers conduct an experiment using dogs. Each dog is placed in a cage with a short middle partition. A light turns on five seconds before the dog receives a painful electric shock through the floor, which stops when the dog jumps over the partition. If researchers count the number of trials each dog needs until it jumps over the partition before the shock is administered, they are most likely studying:

- ☐ A. escape learning. [30%]
- ✓ ☒ B. avoidance learning. [60%]
- ☐ C. habituation. [5%]
- ☐ D. sensitization. [3%]

Correct

61% answered correctly

Explanation:



In operant conditioning, negative reinforcement is the withdrawal of an unpleasant stimulus (eg, ongoing electric shock) following a behavior, which increases the likelihood that the behavior will occur again. Negative reinforcement can lead to escape and/or avoidance learning.

Escape learning occurs when an organism learns how to **terminate** an **ongoing unpleasant stimulus** (eg, a dog jumps over a partition to flee from or stop a continuous electric shock). Escape learning becomes **avoidance learning** when an organism **prevents** coming into **contact** with an **unpleasant stimulus** (eg, a dog jumps over a partition to avoid the electric shock before it occurs).

Because the researchers are counting the number of trials each dog needs until it jumps over the partition before the shock is administered (ie, *avoid the shock*), they are studying avoidance learning.

(Choice A) Escape learning is demonstrated by the dog jumping over the partition to terminate the electric shock, an ongoing unpleasant stimulus. Because the researchers are counting how many trials each dog needs until it jumps over the partition *before the shock was administered*, they are studying avoidance (not escape) learning.

(Choice C) Habituation is a type of learning in which repeated exposure to a stimulus results in a decrease in the strength of a response (eg, after a few minutes one becomes accustomed to a flickering overhead light and no longer notices it).

(Choice D) Sensitization is a type of learning in which repeated exposure to a stimulus results in an increase in the strength of a response (eg, instead of becoming accustomed to a flickering overhead light, one becomes extremely irritated).

Educational objective:

Escape learning occurs when an organism learns how to terminate an ongoing unpleasant stimulus. Avoidance learning occurs when an organism learns how to prevent coming into contact with an unpleasant stimulus before it occurs.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:402008

System:
Learning, Memory, and Cognition

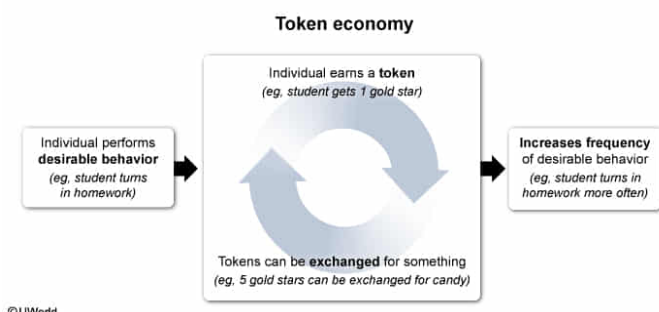
At an inpatient psychiatric hospital, patients are encouraged to engage in certain behaviors through reinforcement. Each time a patient engages in a desired behavior, they are given a secondary reinforcer, which can be exchanged for more attractive rewards. This scenario illustrates which of the following?

- ☐ A. Modeling [3%]
- ☐ B. Classical conditioning [15%]
- ✓ ☒ C. Token economy [80%]
- ☐ D. Stimulus generalization

Correct

80% answered correctly

Explanation:



Operant conditioning occurs when the likelihood of an individual repeating a behavior is influenced by the outcome of that behavior (ie, reinforcement or punishment).

Positive reinforcement increases/maintains behavior through the application of a desirable stimulus (ie, reinforcer). **Primary reinforcers** are **naturally rewarding** (eg, candy), whereas **secondary reinforcers** are **conditioned** to be desirable (eg, money).

A **token economy** positively reinforces certain behaviors through the use of **tokens**, which are **secondary reinforcers** that can be exchanged for a desirable reward. For example, a teacher gives each child a gold star (ie, token) for completing homework, and 5 gold stars can be exchanged for candy.

The encouragement of certain behaviors through the use of secondary

reinforcers (that can be exchanged for rewards) illustrates a token economy.

(Choice A) Modeling describes when an individual learns how to perform a behavior by watching someone else (eg, toddler combs hair after watching father comb hair). The scenario does not describe observation/modeling of certain behaviors.

(Choice B) Classical conditioning occurs when a stimulus that did not previously elicit a meaningful response (ie, neutral stimulus) takes on the properties of a biologically arousing stimulus (ie, unconditioned stimulus) after being paired (eg, infant fears a white rat after it is paired with a loud noise). The scenario does not describe a neutral stimulus taking on the properties of an unconditioned stimulus.

(Choice D) In classical conditioning, stimulus generalization occurs when a conditioned response is elicited by stimuli similar to the original conditioned stimulus (eg, infant who is conditioned to fear white rats also fears white cats). The scenario does not describe the generalization of a learned response.

Educational objective:

Primary reinforcers are naturally rewarding (eg, food), whereas secondary reinforcers are conditioned to be desirable (eg, money). A token economy uses tokens (eg, gold stars) as secondary reinforcers to encourage certain desired behaviors. Tokens can be exchanged for something the individual wants (eg, candy).

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:402009
System:
Learning, Memory, and Cognition